BRAND ORIGINS

THE 130-YEAR PIVOT



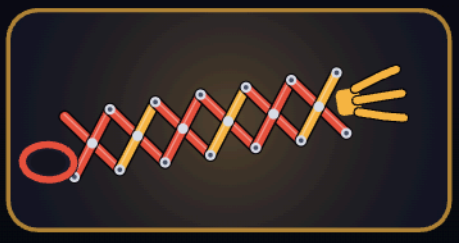
1889
HANDMADE PLAYING CARDS
Fusajiro Yamauchi paints flower cards by hand in Kyoto.



1960s
A TAXI COMPANY
Flopped.



1960s
INSTANT RICE
Flopped.



1966
THE ULTRA HAND
A maintenance engineer's break-time arm toy. Sold over a million.



THEN
VIDEO GAMES
A toy company becomes a video game giant.

In the 60s he also tried, reportedly, a love hotel. Also a flop.

All because a repair guy was messing around at work.

Sources: Wikipedia "History of Nintendo", Nintendo corporate history, Vice, Gizmodo.